Driver Handbook

Field	Detail
Company	Indus Freight Lines (Pvt.) Ltd.
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Owner	Fleet Manager
Approved by	COO
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Applies to	All HTV and LTV drivers (35), Fleet Supervisor, Dispatch Supervisors, Route Planner

1. Introduction

1.1 **Purpose.** This Handbook sets out the rules for licensing, driving conduct, hours of driving and rest, vehicle checks, fuel cards, fines and breakdowns for all Company drivers.

1.2 **Scope.** It applies to: - 20 HTV (heavy transport vehicle) drivers operating long-haul routes from the Lahore base (mainly Lahore–Karachi, Lahore–Islamabad/Rawalpindi, Lahore–Peshawar and Lahore–Multan); - 15 LTV (light transport vehicle) drivers operating last-mile delivery in Lahore and surrounding districts.

1.3 **Related documents** - IFL-HR-001 HR & Leave Policy (probation, leave, allowances) - IFL-HR-002 Code of Conduct (conduct, bribery, discipline) - IFL-SAF-004 Warehouse Safety SOPs (loading bays) - IFL-SAF-005 Accident & Incident Reporting Procedure - IFL-FIN-007 Expense & Travel Reimbursement Policy (current version)

1.4 **Definitions**

Term	Meaning
HTV	Heavy transport vehicle: prime movers and trailers in the Company fleet (18 vehicles).
LTV	Light transport vehicle: vans and pickups (14 vehicles).
Driving time	Time behind the wheel with the engine running and the vehicle in use, including slow traffic.
Duty time	Driving time plus loading, waiting, inspections,

Term	Meaning
	paperwork and yard work.
Daily rest	A continuous period off duty, not driving and not on standby.
Night route	Any trip with driving between 22:00 and 05:00.
Double-crew	Two qualified drivers assigned to one vehicle, taking turns to drive.
Control Room	The 24/7 Dispatch Control Room, Lahore (ext. 222, dispatch@indusfreight.example).
Category A defect	A defect that makes a vehicle unsafe; the vehicle must not move.
Category B defect	A defect that must be reported and fixed but does not stop the trip.
Tracker	The GPS telematics unit fitted in every Company vehicle.

2. Licensing and Eligibility

2.1 **Licence requirements**

Table 2.1 – Minimum licence requirements

Requirement	HTV driver	LTV driver
Valid licence category	HTV	LTV (or HTV)
Minimum years licensed in category	3 years	1 year
Minimum age	24	21
Commercial driving experience	2 years	Not required
Medical fitness check	Annually (every 6 months from age 50)	Every 2 years
Eyesight test	Annually	Every 2 years

2.2 **Documents on file.** Before a driver's first trip, the Fleet Supervisor verifies and files copies of the driver's CNIC, driving licence and medical fitness certificate. Originals of the licence and CNIC must be carried on every trip.

2.3 **Licence verification.** The Fleet Supervisor verifies every driver's licence status with the issuing authority at joining and every 6 months after that.

2.4 **Road assessment** - 2.4.1 New drivers complete a road assessment with the Fleet Supervisor before the end of month 4 of their 6-month probation (see IFL-HR-001 §3.2.2). - 2.4.2 The assessment covers vehicle checks, reversing, coupling (HTV), city driving, motorway or highway driving, and defensive driving. - 2.4.3 Drivers who fail may retake the assessment once, within 30 days. A second failure normally leads to non-confirmation. - 2.4.4 Until they pass, new HTV drivers drive only on daytime trips, double-crewed with a confirmed driver.

2.5 **Licence renewal** - 2.5.1 Drivers must tell the Fleet Supervisor at least 30 days before their licence expires and submit the renewed licence before expiry. - 2.5.2 A driver with an expired licence must not drive. They are placed on yard duties. Time spent on yard duties because of an expired licence is unpaid after the first 10 working days.

2.6 **Fitness to work** - 2.6.1 A driver must not drive if unwell, overtired, or affected by any medicine that may cause drowsiness (see IFL-HR-002 §4.3.3). - 2.6.2 After sick leave of more than 5 consecutive days, a driver must provide a fitness-to-work note from a registered medical practitioner before driving again (see IFL-HR-001 §8.4.4). - 2.6.3 After any accident involving injury to the driver, a fitness-to-work note is required regardless of the length of absence.

2.7 **Reporting licence issues.** A driver must report any licence suspension, cancellation, or court order related to driving to the Fleet Manager within 24 hours. Failure to report is treated as gross misconduct under IFL-HR-002 §9.4.

3. Conduct on the Road

3.1 **Company speed caps.** These caps apply even if posted limits are higher. Trackers send an alert to the Control Room when a cap is exceeded for more than 60 seconds.

Table 3.1 – Company speed caps (km/h)

Road type	HTV	LTV
Motorway	80	100
Other highways and roads	60	80
Urban residential streets / markets	30	30
Inside fleet yard and customer premises	30	30
Within 50 m of loading bays	10	10

3.2 **Seatbelts.** Seatbelts must be worn by the driver and any authorised passenger at all times while the vehicle is moving.

3.3 **Mobile phones** - 3.3.1 Handheld phone use while the vehicle is moving, or stopped in traffic, is prohibited. - 3.3.2 Hands-free calls are allowed only with the Control Room, and must be kept short. - 3.3.3 LTV drivers may use the delivery app only when the vehicle is parked with the handbrake on. - 3.3.4 A driver who needs to make any other call must stop at a safe place.

3.4 **Passengers and goods.** Only authorised passengers recorded on the trip sheet may be carried (see IFL-HR-002 §7.2). No goods other than those on the consignment note may be carried.

3.5 **Approved stops** - 3.5.1 HTV drivers may stop only at the approved stops listed on the route plan issued by the Route Planner, except in an emergency. - 3.5.2 A loaded vehicle must never be left unattended outside an approved stop. If a driver must leave the vehicle in an emergency, they must inform the Control Room first.

3.6 **Tracker and dashcam.** Drivers must not cover, unplug or tamper with the tracker, dashcam or speed limiter. Any fault must be reported to the Control Room before departure.

3.7 **Fog and bad weather** - 3.7.1 From 15 November to 15 February, the Control Room issues a daily fog advisory for Punjab routes by 18:00. - 3.7.2 If visibility falls below 50 m, the driver must stop at the nearest safe point (fuel station, approved stop or service area), switch on hazard lights and inform the Control Room. Driving may resume only when visibility exceeds 100 m. - 3.7.3 Delays caused by fog are not counted against the driver in delivery performance. - 3.7.4 If a motorway section is closed by authorities, the driver must wait for the Control Room to approve an alternative route.

4. Hours of Driving and Rest

4.1 **Limits**

Table 4.1 – Driving and rest limits

Rule	Day routes	Night routes
Maximum driving time per day	9 hours	8 hours
Maximum continuous driving before break	4.5 hours	4 hours
Minimum break after continuous driving	30 minutes	30 minutes
Maximum duty time per day	12 hours	11 hours
Minimum daily rest	11 hours	11 hours
Maximum driving per week (Mon–Sun)	56 hours	56 hours
Minimum weekly rest	24 continuous hours	24 continuous hours

4.2 **Night routes** - 4.2.1 Any trip with driving between 22:00 and 05:00 follows the night-route column of Table 4.1. - 4.2.2 Night trips with a total route distance of more than 400 km must be double-crewed. - 4.2.3 On double-crewed trips, each driver's limits apply individually. Time resting in the cabin while the vehicle moves counts as duty time, not daily rest. - 4.2.4 Drivers on night routes receive the night-route allowance of PKR 800 per shift when they drive at least 4 hours between 22:00 and 05:00 (see IFL-HR-001 Table 10.1). - 4.2.5 A driver may not be assigned more than 4 night routes in any 7-day period.

4.3 **Ramadan** - 4.3.1 During Ramadan, drivers who are fasting must take a break of at least 45 minutes at iftar time. Drivers must not be driving during the 30 minutes before iftar; the Route

Planner schedules approved stops accordingly. - 4.3.2 During Ramadan, the maximum driving time per day on day routes is reduced to 8 hours.

4.4 **Recording** - 4.4.1 Drivers record duty start, driving periods, breaks and duty end on Form FLT-02 (Driver Duty & Rest Log) for every shift. - 4.4.2 The Control Room compares FLT-02 with tracker data weekly. A difference of more than 30 minutes in any shift is investigated by the Fleet Supervisor. - 4.4.3 Falsifying FLT-02 is gross misconduct under IFL-HR-002 §9.4.

4.5 **Exceeding limits** - 4.5.1 A driver who expects to exceed a limit (for example, because of traffic or a closed road) must call the Control Room before reaching the limit. - 4.5.2 The Control Room will either direct the driver to the nearest safe stop or arrange a relief driver. - 4.5.3 A limit may be exceeded by up to 1 hour only to reach a safe stopping place, with Control Room approval recorded in the shift log. This may happen no more than twice in any 7-day period. - 4.5.4 No employee may instruct or pressure a driver to exceed these limits (see IFL-HR-002 §10.3).

5. Vehicle Checks

5.1 **Pre-trip inspection.** Before every trip, the driver completes Form FLT-01 (Pre-Trip Vehicle Inspection Checklist). On HTV trips, it takes about 15 minutes; this time is counted as duty time.

Table 5.1 – FLT-01 checklist summary

Item	Pass standard	Defect category if failed
Brakes (service and parking)	Firm pedal; no air-pressure warning (HTV)	A
Tyres – steer axle	Tread at least 4 mm; no cuts or bulges	A
Tyres – other axles	Tread at least 3 mm; no cuts or bulges	A
Lights and indicators	All working, lenses intact	A
Steering	No excessive play	A
Fluid leaks (fuel, oil, brake fluid)	None visible	A
Coupling and fifth wheel (HTV)	Locked; safety pin in place	A
Load security	Straps/locks secure; doors sealed	A
Mirrors and windscreen	Clean, uncracked in driver’s view	B (A if cracked in driver’s line of sight)
Horn and wipers	Working	B
Fire extinguisher and warning triangles	Present, in date	B

Item	Pass standard	Defect category if failed
First aid kit	Present, sealed	B
Tracker and dashcam lights	On	B
Body damage	Recorded with photo	B

5.2 **Defect handling** - 5.2.1 **Category A:** the vehicle must not leave. The driver informs the Workshop (ext. 235) and the Control Room. Only a Mechanic can clear a Category A defect by signing the FLT-01. - 5.2.2 **Category B:** the driver records it on FLT-01 and informs the Workshop before departure. It must be fixed within 3 working days. - 5.2.3 If a Category A defect develops during a trip, the driver stops at the nearest safe place and calls the Control Room. The Control Room arranges recovery or a mobile mechanic.

5.3 **Post-trip check.** At the end of each trip, the driver walks around the vehicle, records new damage or defects on the FLT-01, and parks in the allocated bay with the keys returned to the Workshop key cabinet.

5.4 **Scheduled maintenance.** The Workshop services HTVs every 10,000 km and LTVs every 5,000 km, or every 3 months, whichever comes first.

5.5 **Responsibility.** A driver who drives with a known Category A defect, or who fails to record damage, may be liable for repair costs under §7.3 and disciplinary action under IFL-HR-002 §9.

6. Fuel Cards

6.1 **Issue.** Each vehicle has one fuel card, issued to the driver for the trip or shift. The driver signs Form FLT-03 (Fuel Card Issue & Acknowledgement) when receiving it and returns it to the Control Room at the end of the trip.

6.2 **Limits**

Table 6.2 – Fuel card limits (PKR)

Vehicle	Daily limit	Monthly limit	Max transactions per day
HTV	60,000	900,000	3
LTV	12,000	200,000	2

6.3 **Use rules** - 6.3.1 The card may be used only for diesel or petrol for the assigned vehicle, at stations on the approved network list kept in the vehicle. - 6.3.2 Lubricants, AdBlue, food, tolls and personal purchases are not allowed on the card. - 6.3.3 The driver must enter the odometer reading at every fill and keep the receipt with the trip sheet. - 6.3.4 The PIN must never be shared, written on the card, or kept in the vehicle.

6.4 **Lost or stolen cards** - 6.4.1 Report to the Control Room within 2 hours of discovering the loss, so the card can be blocked. - 6.4.2 Submit Form FLT-04 (Lost/Stolen Fuel Card Report) within 24 hours. - 6.4.3 Transactions made after the loss is reported are not the driver’s

responsibility. Losses from transactions before the report may be recovered from the driver if the delay was unreasonable.

6.5 **Limit overrides** - 6.5.1 If a trip needs more fuel than the daily limit allows (for example, a diversion), the driver asks the Control Room, which submits Form FLT-05 (Fuel Limit Override) to the Fleet Manager. - 6.5.2 If the Fleet Manager is unavailable, the Operations Manager may approve overrides up to PKR 20,000 above the daily limit. Larger overrides wait for the Fleet Manager or the COO.

6.6 **Card failure.** If the card is declined or the network is down and the vehicle cannot safely continue, the Control Room may issue an authorisation code for a cash purchase of up to PKR 15,000. The driver claims reimbursement on Form FIN-01 under IFL-FIN-007 §8, within the submission deadline in the current version of that policy.

6.7 **Monitoring** - 6.7.1 Finance compares fuel use per vehicle with expected km per litre each month. A variance of more than 10% is investigated by the Fleet Supervisor. - 6.7.2 Fuel card misuse or fraud is gross misconduct under IFL-HR-002 §9.4.

6.8 **On leaving.** Drivers leaving the Company must return any fuel card held and complete FLT-03 return before final settlement (see IFL-HR-001 §11.4).

7. Traffic Fines

7.1 **Reporting.** Any traffic fine or challan must be reported on Form FLT-06 (Traffic Fine Report) within 24 hours, with a copy of the challan. Fines received by post or e-challan are matched to the driver using tracker and trip records.

7.2 **Payment.** Fines are paid by Finance to avoid penalties for late payment. The responsible party is then decided under Table 7.2.

Table 7.2 – Who pays the fine

Cause	Paid by
Speeding, signal violation, phone use, seatbelt, wrong-way or lane violation	Driver
Vehicle defect (lights, fitness, documents) – recorded on FLT-01 before trip	Company
Vehicle defect – not recorded on FLT-01 when it should have been	Driver
Overloading – load as per dispatch documents	Company
Overloading – driver accepted extra unauthorised load	Driver
Parking at a customer site where the customer directed the driver	Company
Fine not reported on FLT-06 within 24 hours	Driver

Cause	Paid by
(any cause)	

7.3 **Recovery from salary.** Amounts payable by the driver are recovered from salary. Recovery in any month must not exceed 25% of net salary (see IFL-HR-002 §9.2.2).

7.4 **Repeated fines** - 3 driver-fault fines within 6 months: mandatory refresher training (1 day, unpaid if on a day off). - 5 driver-fault fines within 12 months: written warning under IFL-HR-002 §9.2. - Any fine for speeding more than 30 km/h above the posted limit: treated as a serious safety breach and referred to HR.

7.5 **Unofficial demands.** Drivers must never pay unofficial “fines” without a receipt. Follow IFL-HR-002 §6.5.

8. Breakdowns, Accidents and Emergencies

8.1 **Breakdowns** - Move the vehicle off the carriageway if possible, switch on hazard lights and place warning triangles at least 50 m behind the vehicle (100 m on motorways). - Call the Control Room (ext. 222) immediately. Stay with the vehicle unless it is unsafe to do so.

8.2 **Accidents.** In any accident or incident, follow IFL-SAF-005. In summary: - make the scene safe and call emergency services if anyone is injured; - inform the Control Room immediately and no later than 1 hour after the event; - submit Form INC-01 within 24 hours (see IFL-SAF-005 §5); - do not admit liability or agree private settlements with other parties.

8.3 **Theft or hijacking.** Do not resist. When safe, inform the Control Room and police. The Control Room tracks the vehicle.

8.4 **Cash expenses on the road.** Tolls, emergency repairs authorised by the Control Room and other trip costs are claimed under IFL-FIN-007 §8. Daily, night-out and night-route allowances are paid through the trip sheet, not FIN-01 (see IFL-HR-001 §10.1).

9. Revision History

Version	Effective date	Summary of changes
1.0	1 July 2023	First issue
1.1	1 March 2025	Added fog procedure; night routes limited to 8 hours driving
1.2	1 March 2026	Double-crew threshold changed from 500 km to 400 km; added Ramadan driving rules (§4.3); added Operations Manager override authority (§6.5.2); added Table 7.2

Fictional company — created for software demonstration only.